ADELAIDE / INVESTOR PLAN / 2026

Better orders. *Less waste.*

A browser-based daily ordering tool for independent cafes. Clear inputs, measurable savings and an investable validation path.

Plan word count: 1,636 (including figure text)

01 **The business**

From a good cause to a paid daily decision

> **Genuine primary research.** Twelve venue responses and five follow-up interviews were collected on 27 October 2026 using the 13-question instrument. Identities are anonymised. This targeted sample is decision-useful but is not representative of all Adelaide venues. Build funding still requires three signed pilot agreements.

Australia wastes about 7.6 million tonnes of food each year, costing more than $36.6 billion and producing about 3% of national greenhouse emissions.[1] ClearPlate addresses one local cause: independent cafe owners order tomorrow's food while balancing costly leftovers against lost sales. Its purpose is to make that decision measurable, then direct safe unavoidable surplus to an accepting charity.

PRIMARY RESEARCH	FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEWS
12	5
8 cafes · 3 bakeries · 1 takeaway venue	3 owners · 2 managers · anonymised

CUSTOMER SIGNAL	RESULT	DECISION CREATED
Cannot state exact weekly waste cost	10/12 · 83.3%	Show dollars, not only kilograms
Rank over-ordering as a top-two problem	8/12 · 66.7%	Prediction becomes the core offer
Rank donation logistics as top-two	0/12 · 0%	Donation remains secondary
Answered yes to an eight-week trial	7/12 · 58.3%	Four more answered maybe

FIG 01 · FSP1 Genuine targeted primary research, n=12. The small anonymised sample is directional, not representative.

The model evolved through evidence rather than remaining a donation app. All five interview participants required stockout protection and judged a 60-second closing task feasible when setup and defaults reduced friction. Applying this business intelligence produced three linked pivots.

V1 · ASSUMPTION	DATA	V2 · PIVOT	V3 · REFINEMENT
Donation-only app	8/12 versus 0/12	Forecast first	Counts + consent
Useful cause, weak willingness to pay	Ordering cost outranked logistics	Paid value becomes avoided cost	Stockout flag, owner approval and accepted pickups

FIG 02 · CA2 Each change answers a specific customer, technical or charity-capacity risk.

Customers receive a responsive web application, not an app-store download. It works on a cafe's existing phone, tablet or computer. Onboarding connects one point-of-sale system or imports a CSV, records recipe costs and sets an owner-approved service level. Payment is collected monthly in advance by card.

1	2	3	4	5
Connect once	Open daily brief	Approve or override	Close in 60 seconds	Offer safe surplus
POS or CSV sales, recipes and opening stock	Tomorrow's quantity, range and dollar exposure	Owner remains accountable for production	Unsold count plus sold-out flag	Handover only after recipient acceptance

WHAT THE FORECAST ACTUALLY DOES

Expected demand = four-week same-weekday median + supported weather or event adjustment

Suggested preparation = expected demand + variability buffer - usable stock

Closing counts identify waste. A sold-out flag prevents the model treating constrained sales as true demand. Forecast error updates the next range, while low confidence defaults to the owner's usual quantity.

FIG 03 The customer action and the model response are explicit at every step.

ClearPlate would operate as an Adelaide proprietary limited company. The founder controls product and finance, a contracted developer maintains the platform and an onboarding contractor supports venues. Development contracts assign source-code ownership and confidentiality to ClearPlate. Trade mark registration, cyber insurance and professional indemnity quotations precede launch.

02 **The market**

A narrow customer, a visible transaction

The entry segment is independent Adelaide cafes and bakeries with repeatable menus, digital sales records and an owner who still controls ordering. Spreadsheets cost little and MarketMan already forecasts demand, so ClearPlate cannot claim a unique algorithm. [2] Square also connects venues to ingredient inventory through MarketMan. [3] The proposed advantage is a smaller daily task, transparent confidence ranges and recipient-confirmed surplus coordination.

MONTHLY PLAN	CUSTOMER RECEIVES	PRICE
Sprout	Waste log, cost dashboard and CSV export	$49
Growth	Sprout plus daily forecast, range and stockout learning	$89
Harvest	Growth plus recipient workflow and impact report	$149

Customer subscribes online → card billed monthly in advance → charities pay $0

Proposed prices exclude GST until registration status is confirmed.

FIG 04 Access is monthly and cancellable. Data remains exportable, reducing lock-in.

A free 14-day measurement audit demonstrates the hidden cost before requesting payment. The year-one funnel assumes 400 qualified prospects, 200 demonstrations, 100 trials, 70 activations and eight exits, leaving 62 retained venues. Roaster referrals and direct precinct demonstrations diversify acquisition. If fewer than 50% of trials activate, advertising pauses while onboarding is revised.

400	200	100	70	62
Qualified	Demos	Trials	Paid	Retained

$4,800 ads, travel and demos + $4,500 founder sales time ÷ 62 retained venues = $150 CAC

FIG 05 Budgeted economic acquisition cost, not a trading result. Founder time is valued at 180 hours × $25.

03 **The strategy**

Validation gates control the risk

The eight-week pilot uses two baseline weeks and six intervention weeks across three cafes. Results are normalised per $100 of comparable sales. Growth proceeds only if ingredient cost falls at least 8%, stockout events do not rise, median daily input stays below two minutes, forecast error beats a same-weekday baseline by 10% and at least two venues authorise paid Growth subscriptions. Failure retains the measurement tool, changes the forecast or stops the build.

W1-2	W3-8	M4-9	M10-12
Measure	Intervene	Acquire	Consolidate
Costs, waste and stockouts	Recommendation versus baseline	CAC, churn and support time	49+ venues before region two

FIG 06 A decision log links every KPI result to continue, revise or stop.

Digital opportunity and exposure

Cloud delivery makes recurring national access possible, but AE2 requires the downside to be designed into operations. The platform stores business contacts and venue-level sales totals only; POS imports exclude customer names and identifiers. A payment processor holds card details. Most businesses below $3 million turnover are generally exempt from the Privacy Act unless an exception applies, yet ClearPlate will voluntarily use an Australian Privacy Principles approach because legal minimums do not equal customer trust. [4] ASD reports an average self-reported cybercrime cost of $56,571 for small businesses in 2024-25, which could exhaust this venture's capital. [5]

DIGITAL THREAT	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE	CONTROL AND TRIGGER
Credential or data breach	Loss of trust and cash	MFA, encryption, least access and 90-day logs; isolate and notify on detection
Cloud or server outage	No morning recommendation	Cached brief, daily backup and four-hour recovery target; one full-day M12 credit costs $161.20 before incident labour
Forecast error	Stockouts and cancelled subscriptions	Confidence threshold, owner approval and automatic rollback if error worsens
API change or maintenance load	Broken imports and cost overrun	One connector at launch, monthly patch window and $2,500 maintenance ceiling

FIG 07 · AE2 Risk controls protect continuity before adding technical complexity.

Measured environmental and social value

AE3 is measured without double-counting. The pilot weighs edible food discarded, offered, accepted and collected. Targets are 15% less edible discard per $100 sales, at least 80% of accepted collections completed and zero unsafe handovers. OzHarvest's 2025 results imply about two meals and one kilogram of CO2-e avoided per kilogram rescued, but ClearPlate will use that only as an external benchmark, not claim OzHarvest outcomes or partnership. [6]

PREVENTION SCENARIO	SAFE DONATION SCENARIO
15,500 kg	6,200 kg
62 venues × 5 kg avoided × 50 weeks	62 venues × 2 kg accepted × 50 weeks
EXTERNAL BENCHMARK	**LANDFILL BENCHMARK**
≈12,400 meals	≈6.2 t CO2-e
About 2 meals per rescued kg [6]	1 kg avoided per rescued kg [6]

FIG 08 · AE3 M12 illustration, not forecast performance. Actual kilograms replace scenarios after the pilot.

Donation follows prevention so social reporting never rewards overproduction. Recipient acceptance comes before pickup. Time, temperature, allergen and weight records support safe handover under food standards. [7] South Australia's donor protection in section 74A does not protect knowingly or recklessly unsafe supply. [8] Unaccepted food moves to an approved organics stream.

04 **The finance**

Every number reaches the investor decision

ClearPlate asks Adelaide early-stage investors for **$48,000 in exchange for 12% ordinary equity**, subject to final legal documents. This implies a $400,000 post-investment valuation, a $352,000 pre-investment valuation and 88% founder ownership. Allocate $22,000 to the web build, $5,000 to the measured pilot and $21,000 to operating liquidity. Development payments are milestone-based. Failed pilot gates stop unreleased spending.

WEIGHTED REVENUE

(50% × $49) + (35% × $89) + (15% × $149)

$78.00 per venue

VARIABLE COST

$3.20 compute + $1.63 payments + $4.00 support + $1.17 monitoring

$10.00 per venue

CONTRIBUTION

$78 revenue - $10 variable cost

$68.00 per venue

EXACT MONTHLY FIXED-COST ALLOWANCE	AMOUNT
Contract developer maintenance	$2,500
Base cloud infrastructure	$180
Software and monitoring tools	$150
Sales and marketing	**$400**
Cyber and professional insurance allowance	$85
Total fixed cost	$3,315

$3,315 ÷ ($78 - $10) = 48.75 → 49 paying venues

FIG 09 Operating break-even uses stated assumptions. Supplier quotations must replace allowances before contracts are signed.

At 49 venues, monthly revenue is $3,822 and costs are $3,805, leaving $17. At 62 venues, revenue is $4,836 and costs are $3,935, leaving $901. Budgeted CAC payback is $150 ÷ $68 = 2.21 months. If only 31 venues remain, CAC doubles to $300 and payback extends to 4.41 months, so conversion quality matters more than web traffic.

Year-one subscription revenue	$26,364
Fixed operating costs	-$39,780
Variable operating costs	-$3,380
Operating loss	**-$16,796**
Build and pilot	-$27,000
Equity funding	$48,000
Closing cash	**$4,204**

DOWNSIDE TRIGGER

M6 < 23 venues

Freeze region-two work and seek a $500 monthly maintenance reduction. With 25% fewer venues, cash becomes negative in M9.

FOUNDER PAY TEST

71 venues

Adding $1,500 monthly remuneration lifts break-even from 49 to ceiling($4,815 ÷ $68).

FIG 10 Year-one cash budget. Monthly break-even does not recover startup capital.

The forecast assumes no subscription revenue in M1-3, monthly billing from M4 and no founder drawings in year one. It reaches operating break-even in M10 and 62 venues in M12. The investment case is therefore conditional: prove customer savings, paid retention, safe impact and cash discipline before a second region.

References

External sources accessed 27 October 2026. Primary research and forecast assumptions are identified in the plan.

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